

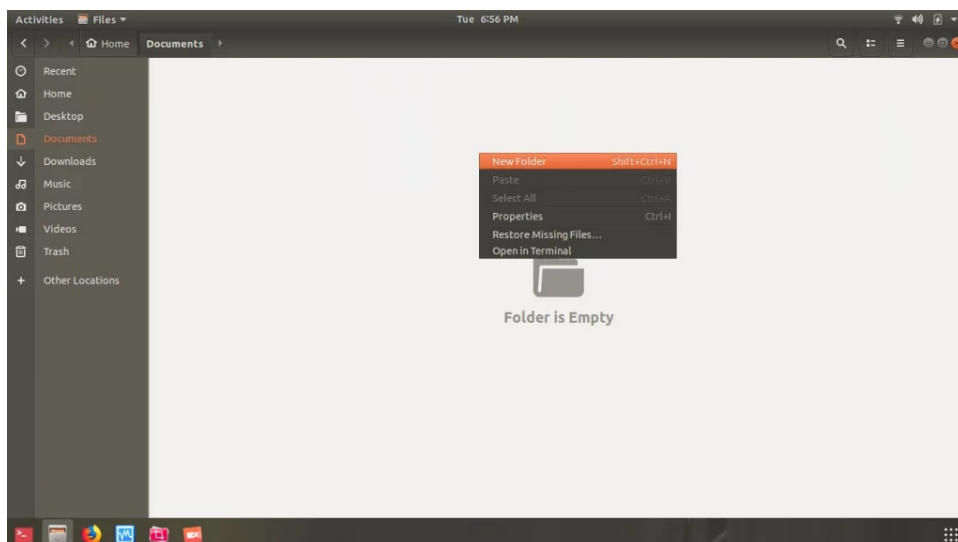
UNIX/LINUX How To Add 'New Document' Option / Custom templates In Right Click Context Menu In Ubuntu/LINUX

Written by Sk | July 24, 2024

The other day, I was collecting reference notes for [Linux package managers](#) on various online sources. When I tried to create a text file to save those notes, I noticed that the 'New document' option is

the "new document" option is not included in Ubuntu GNOME editions. Luckily, I have found an easy solution to add 'New Document' option in right click context menu in Ubuntu 18.04 LTS desktop.

As you can see in the following screenshot, the "New Document" option is missing in the right-click context menu of Nautilus file manager.



new document option is missing in right-click context menu ubuntu 18.04

If you want to add this option, just follow the steps given below.

Add 'New Document' Option In Right Click Context Menu In Ubuntu

First, make sure you have **~/Templates** directory in your system. If it is not available create one like below.

```
$ mkdir ~/Templates
```

Next open the Terminal application and cd into the **~/Templates** folder using command:

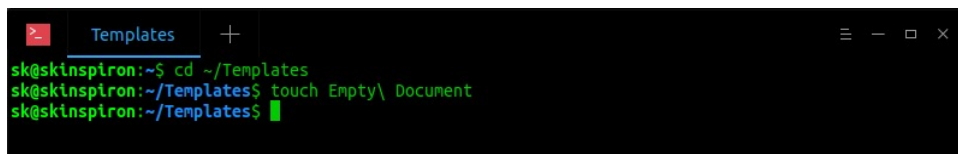
```
$ cd ~/Templates
```

Create an empty file:

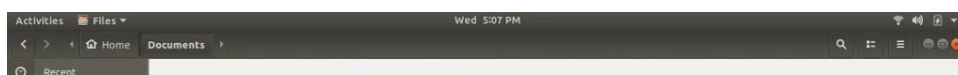
```
$ touch Empty\ Document
```

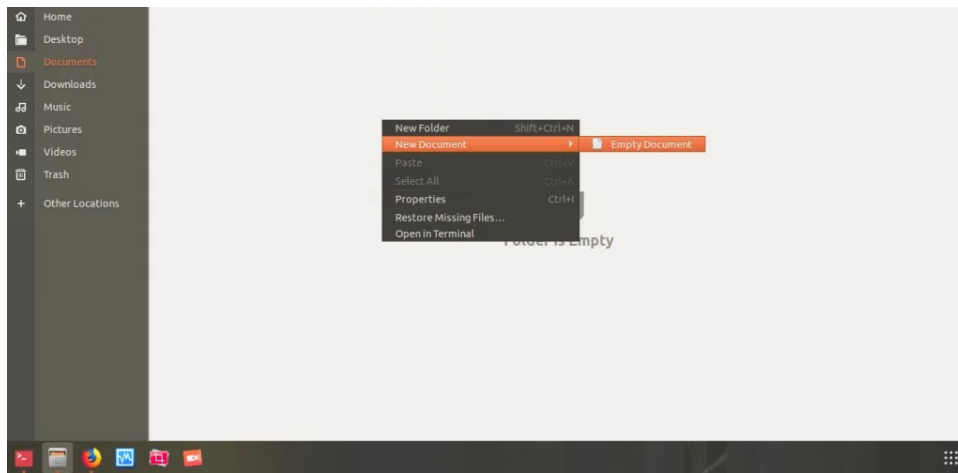
Or,

```
$ touch "Empty Document"
```

A screenshot of a Linux terminal window. The title bar shows a red icon, the word "Templates", and a plus sign. The terminal content shows the user 'sk@skinspiron' at the prompt '~\$' typing 'cd ~/Templates', then at the prompt '~/Templates\$' typing 'touch Empty\ Document', and finally at the prompt '~/Templates\$' with a green cursor. The terminal has standard window controls (minimize, maximize, close) on the right.

Now open your Nautilus file manager and check if "New Document" option is added in context menu.





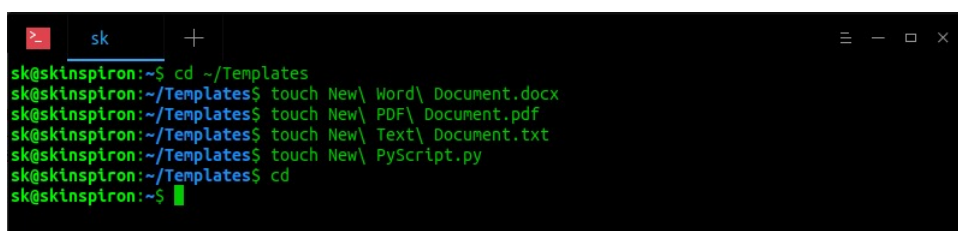
Add 'New Document' Option In Right Click Context Menu In Ubuntu 18.04

As you can see in the above screenshot, the "New Document" option is back again.

You can also additionally add options for different files types like below.

```
$ cd ~/Templates
```

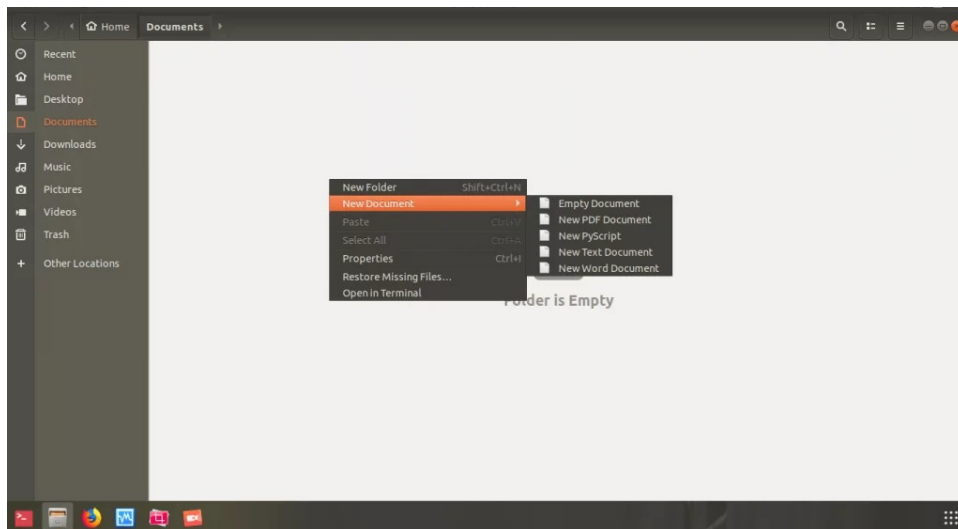
```
$ touch New\ Word\ Document.docx
$ touch New\ PDF\ Document.pdf
$ touch New\ Text\ Document.txt
$ touch New\ PyScript.py
```



Add options for different files types in New Document sub-menu

Please note that all files should be created inside the **~/Templates** directory.

Now, open the Nautilus and check if the newly created file types are present in "New Document" sub-menu.



If you want to remove any file type from the sub-menu, simply remove the appropriate file from the Templates directory.

```
$ rm ~/Templates/New\ Word\ Document.docx
```

I am wondering why this option has been removed in recent Ubuntu GNOME editions. I use it frequently. However, it is easy to re-enable this option in couple minutes.

Thanks for stopping by!